Adam William Baker

Curriculum Vitae

Department of Psychology & Institute on Aging
University of Wisconsin-Madison
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EDUCATION

University of Wisconsin-Madison, Madison, WI — August 2023-Present
Ph.D. in Social Psychology; minor in Educational Psychology (Expected 2028)
M.S. in Psychology — 2024
Advisor: Carol D. Ryff

University of North Carolina-Asheville, Asheville, NC — August 2020-December 2022
B.A. in Psychology; minor in Philosophy — 2022
Summa Cum Laude

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

Baker, A. W., Song, J., & Ryff, C. D. (2026). Understanding varieties of religious types: A latent profile analysis of U.S. national data. Psychology of Religion and Spirituality. Advance online publication. https://doi.org/10.1037/rel0000631

Ryff, C. D., Cha, S. E., Baker, A. W., & Song, J. (2025). Understanding links between race/ethnicity and health: Does participation in the musical arts matter? Psychology of Aesthetics, Creativity, and the Arts. Advance online publication. https://doi.org/10.1037/aca0000805

MANUSCRIPTS UNDER REVIEW

Baker, A. W., Song, J., & Ryff, C. D. Linking varieties of religious experience to eudaimonic well-being: Does race matter? Manuscript under review at Mental Health, Religion & Culture

MANUSCRIPTS IN PROGRESS

Baker, A. W., & Ryff, C. D. Stability and change in profiles of religiosity across midlife: A latent transition analysis

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Talks

Baker, A. W., & Ryff, C. D. (May 2026). Stability and change in profiles of religiosity across midlife: A latent transition analysis. Talk presented at the Midlife in the United States (MIDUS) Meeting, Madison, WI, USA.

Baker, A. W., Song, J., & Ryff, C. D. (May 2025). *Understanding varieties of religious types via latent profile analysis of U.S. national data (MIDUS).* Talk presented at the Midlife in the United States (MIDUS) Meeting, Madison, WI, USA.

Baker, A. W., Song, J., & Ryff, C. D. (May 2024). *Linking varieties of religious experience to eudaimonic well-being: Does race matter?* Talk presented at the Midlife in the United States (MIDUS) Meeting, Madison, WI, USA.

Baker, A. W. (April 2022). *How doing the right thing makes things better: The philosophy of Mencius and the concept of innate goodness*. Southern Appalachian Undergraduate Philosophy Conference, Asheville, NC, USA.

Brown, T. L., Willoughby, E. A., & **Baker, A. W.** (April 2022). *The cognitive anatomy of color-word Stroop effects*. Carolina Psychology Conference, Buies Creek, NC, USA.

Baker, A. W., & Pascoe, E. (April 2022). Different perceptions of classroom settings. National Conference of Undergraduate Research, Online.

Brown, T. L., Willoughby, E. A., & **Baker, A. W.** (March 2022). *The cognitive anatomy of color-word Stroop effects*. Southeastern Psychological Association Conference, Hilton Head, SC, USA.

Baker, A. W., & Pascoe, E. (November 2021). Different perceptions of classroom settings. Fall Symposium at UNC Asheville, Asheville, NC, USA.

Posters

Baker, A. W., Song, J., & Ryff, C. D. (February 2026). *Understanding varieties of religious types via latent profile analysis of U.S. national data (MIDUS).* Poster presented at the Religion & Spirituality Preconference, Society for Personality and Social Psychology (SPSP), Chicago, IL, USA.

Baker, A. W., Song, J., & Ryff, C. D. (February 2026). *Understanding varieties of religious types via latent profile analysis of U.S. national data (MIDUS).* Poster presented at the 26th SPSP Annual Convention, Chicago, IL, USA.

Baker, A. W., Song, J., & Ryff, C. D. (February 2025). *Linking varieties of religious experience to eudaimonic well-being: Does race matter?* Poster presented at the Religion & Spirituality Preconference, SPSP, Denver, CO, USA.

Baker, A. W., Song, J., & Ryff, C. D. (February 2025). *Linking varieties of religious experience to eudaimonic well-being: Does race matter?* Poster presented at the 25th SPSP Annual Convention, Denver, CO, USA.

Community / Public Presentations

Baker, A. W., Song, J., & Ryff, C. D. (February 2024). *Linking varieties of religious experience to eudaimonic well-being: Does race matter?* Poster presented at the 35th Institute on Aging Annual Colloquium, University of Wisconsin–Madison, Madison, WI, USA.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

University of Wisconsin-Madison, Madison, WI August 2023 – Present
Graduate Research Assistant

- Conduct research on religiosity and psychological well-being using large-scale longitudinal data (e.g., MIDUS)
- Apply person-centered methods and longitudinal modeling
- Contribute to manuscript development and collaborative projects
- Data entry for the MIDUS Biomarker Project
- **Supervisor**: Carol D. Ryff, PhD

University of North Carolina, Asheville, NC March 2021 – December 2022
Senior Research Assistant

- Conducted and coordinated experimental research on attention and cognitive control (Stroop paradigms)
- Managed participant sessions and assisted with data analysis
- **Supervisor**: Tracy L. Brown, PhD

University of North Carolina, Asheville, NC March 2021 – August 2022
Independent Undergraduate Research

- Designed and conducted survey study on classroom experiences in online and in-person settings during COVID
- Collected and analyzed data
- **Supervisor**: Elizabeth Pascoe, PhD

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Piedmont College, Athens, Georgia October 2015 – August 2016
Tutor, Writing and Critical Thinking

HONORS & AWARDS

Summa Cum Laude, *University of North Carolina, Asheville* 2022
Distinction in Psychology, *University of North Carolina, Asheville* 2022
University Research Scholar Designation, *University of North Carolina, Asheville* 2022
Best Professional Paper Finalists, *SEPA* 2022

MEMBERSHIPS

American Psychological Association, Graduate Student Affiliate; APA Division 36 (Society for the Psychology of Religion and Spirituality), Graduate Student Affiliate; Psi Chi, The International Honor Society in Psychology